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# 3. Experiment on CISCO Packet Tracer (Simulation Tool)

**Aim:-** To study the Packet tracer tool installation and User interface Overview

**Introduction:-**

Packet tracer is a tool to simulate network design, modelling tool.

*. It allows you to model complex systems without the need to dedicate equipments.

*. It helps you to practice your network configurations and troubleshooting skills via computers or an Android or iOS based mobile devices.

*. It is avilable for both the Linux and Windows desktop.

*. Protocol in Packet tracer are good coded to work and behave in the same way as they would on real hardware.

User Interface Overview:-

The layout of packet tracer is divided into several components.

*. Menu-bar - This is a common menu found in all software applications it is used to open, save, print, change preference, and so on.

*. Main-toolbar - This has a shortcut icons to menu options that are commonly accessed such as open, save, zoom, undo and redo and on the right-hand side is an icon for entering network information for the current network.

*. Logical / Physical tabs:- These tabs allow you to toggle between the logical and physical work areas.

*. Workspace - This is the area where topologies are created and simulated are displayed.

*. Common tools bar - This toolbar provides control for manupulating topologies

such as select, move layout, place note, delete, inspect, resize shape and add simple/ complex PDU.

*. Real-time / Simulation tabs - This toolbar tabs is used to toggle between real and simulated modes. Buttons are also provided to control the time and to capture the packets.

*. Network components box :- This contains all the network end devices in the packet tracer tool.

Analyse the behaviour of network devices using CISCO packet tracer simulator :-

*. From the network component box, click and drag-and-drop components

*. Click on Connections :-

i). Use copper straigth through cabel

ii). Select the ethernet of PC end and connect to the one port of HUB

iii). Similarly perform for all connections

*. Click on the PC connected to the hub go to the desktop tab, click on IP section and then configuration and enter static IP address in the absense of the DHCP.

*. Observe the flow of PDU PDU from source PC to destination PC on real time mode simulation

*. Repeat the step 3 and 5 for all connected to the HUB

*. Absorb the PDU forwarding and write your observation and conclusion about the behaviour.

Result :-

These are the basic and core features of the CISCO packet tracer tools.